CSC-192 Seminar #7: Career in IT Consulting
Speaker: Jason Francis, Accenture, Inc.

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CSC 192

March 3, 2025

Q1: What is the Mission (in general) of a Consulting Company?

Consulting companies like Accenture come in when you are running a big company, and you've got this huge project but have no idea how to make it work. Their whole mission is to help other companies do their jobs better. The speaker mentioned that his company don't own the projects they work on, but they just bring in their expertise, fix things, improve processes, and then move on. Thinking of them as professional problem solvers for businesses. Whether it's setting up a new system, managing data, or figuring out how to make things run smoother, consulting companies provide the knowledge and skills to get it done.

Q2: What does Accenture's IT division do for a business Model?

According to the video, Accenture's IT division is like the tech wizards behind the scenes, making sure businesses have the best systems in place. They help companies move their data to the cloud, set up software like SAP, manage security, and even build entire systems from scratch. A big part of what they do is making sure businesses run efficiently by automating tasks, integrating new tools, and keeping up with the latest tech trends. For example, they worked on a welfare system that manages benefits for California residents. They take care of the tech side so businesses can focus on their customers.

Q3: List 3 Pro's & Cons of working for a consulting company?

Pros:

- Fast Learning: You get to work on different projects, learn new things quickly, and become an expert in multiple areas.
- Networking: You meet lots of people from different industries, which can open doors for future opportunities.
- Good Pay & Growth: Since consulting is fast paced, there are often chances for promotions and salary increases.

Cons:

- Work-Life Balance: It can get intense, with long hours and sometimes weekend work.
- Constant Change: You may have to switch projects often, which can be stressful if you prefer stability.
- Travel: In some cases, you might have to travel frequently, which is fun at first but can get exhausting.

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Q4: What Skillsets do Consulting companies look for in a Candidate?

Speaker mentioned that Consulting companies love people who can solve problems fast and work well with others. They look for technical skills like coding, cloud computing, and data management. However, just as important are soft skills, good communication, teamwork, and the ability to adapt quickly. Since consultants have to deal with clients, being able to explain things clearly and build relationships is key. Also, time management and organization are big deals because projects move fast, and you need to keep track of everything.

Q5: List 5 "Career Growth & Success Factors" in a Consulting Organization?

- Big Picture Thinking: Understanding not just your task but how it fits into the whole project makes you valuable.
- Never Stop Learning: Getting certifications, staying updated on new technology, and constantly improving yourself is key.
- Building Relationships: Connecting with clients and coworkers helps open opportunities for promotions and new projects.
- Taking Ownership: Being the person who can handle an entire project from start to finish makes you stand out.
- Knowing When to Move On: Sometimes, growth means leaving a comfortable job and taking on a new challenge.

Q6: List Job Search tips discussed in the Seminar?

- Know the Company: Do your research before interviews so you can ask good questions.
- Highlight Your Experience: Talk about your senior projects or past work to show what you've done.
- Be Honest About What You Don't Know: If you don't know something, explain how you find the answer.
- Ask About Growth: See if the company supports training, certifications, and career development.
- Consider More Than Salary: Benefits, work-life balance, and job stability matter just as much as the paycheck.
- Show Initiative: Taking notes, asking thoughtful questions, and showing enthusiasm makes a great impression.